

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

M IS FOR...

Mastering Malayalam is no small feat, especially for those unfamiliar with the tongue-twisting intricacies of Kerala's home spiel. But **Priyanka Gandhi Vadra**, the new debutant MP from Wayanad, is determined to bridge the linguistic gap to get to know her constituents better. Her plan? Learn to speak Malayalam in a year. That might not be so easy, for adding to the challenge will be the local colloquialisms, including that of the Moplahs (Muslims) who make up a fair share of the population. Then there are the tribal communities who have their own dialects. Priyanka is also in the process of finding a home in Wayanad, signalling her intent to spend more time in the constituency. As for her Malayalam tutor? Well, the candidate remains a closely guarded secret.

Pawar Play

What unfolds when two sparring Pawars cross paths? Sparks, of course, peppered with a dash of political banter. NCP chief **Ajit Pawar** couldn't resist needling his nephew and NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar) faction leader Rohit Pawar about his razor-thin victory margin in the Karjat-Jamkhed seat in the Maharashtra assembly poll. "You were saved by a whisker. What would have happened if I had held a rally there?" quipped Ajit, ensuring the family feud found its way into their repartee.



MANDAR DEODHAR

Better Halves



Unlike Kalpana Soren's barnstorming effort in Jharkhand, a number of politicians' spouses are making quieter political debuts elsewhere. In Meghalaya, CM Conrad Sangma's wife, **Mehtab Chandee Sangma**, clinched victory in the Gambegre bypoll. Mehtab, a doctor by training, joins the illustrious Sangma political dynasty, following in the footsteps of her late father-in-law and Lok Sabha speaker Purno A. Sangma, Conrad, and siblings-in-law James and Agatha. Neighbouring Assam also welcomed a 'better half' in the form of Diptimayee Choudhury who steps into the shoes of her husband, Asom Gana Parishwad veteran Phani Bhusan Choudhury, to represent Bongaigaon in the assembly. Phani Bhusan represented the seat for an astounding 41 years, but has now moved to Parliament.

Switch it off

Telangana CM **A. Revanth Reddy** marked his first year in office with a notice asking his officers to show their thrifty side. In a circular issued by chief secretary A. Santhi Kumari, departments have been told that foreign jaunts will be a no-no unless 'absolutely necessary', there will be no shiny new vehicles in the parking lot, and staff will ensure that all electrical equipment is switched off when they leave office. The directive was also a reminder that the state faces a towering Rs 7 lakh crore debt.



HOME SCORES

There's a baby boom on in Indian cricket. As BCCI secretary **Jay Shah** gears up to take over as ICC chairperson, he's celebrating a hat-trick of his own. He and wife Rishita welcomed a baby boy, their third child after two daughters. Jay, the son of Union home minister Amit Shah, tied the knot with college sweetheart Rishita Patel in 2015. Incidentally, Shah Sr is often seen enjoying his brief Ahmedabad breaks with his granddaughters. At the 2025 mega player auction in Jeddah, IPL chairman Arun Dhumal toasted "India's off-field captain" while also cheering for on-field skipper Rohit Sharma, who became a dad for the second time on November 15.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

Kaushik Deka with Jeemon Jacob, Jumana Shah, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Amarnath K. Menon